



Chaulmoogra trees grow in Hawaii and other places with tropical climates. The trees have velvety fruits, which are filled with oily seeds.

In 1916, Alice became very ill and died. She may have breathed in chlorine gas by mistake while teaching.

The Ball Method

Alice threw herself into solving the problem. In less than a year, she managed to create a different form of the oil. This contained the same bacteria-fighting ingredients as the first version, but the difference was that it could dissolve in water. This made injections much safer and far less painful.

This treatment was introduced in 1916 and used for decades, until a new cure was invented in 1943. Sadly, Alice died before she could see how her work improved life for people suffering from Hansen's.



Someone else continued Alice's work with chaulmoogra oil, and even took credit for it. The truth was discovered years later, and the treatment became known as the "Ball Method."